Goldman Sachs Research

Equity Research

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Kuaishou Technology (1024.HK)

Kling raises up to US$3bn implying US$15bn pre-money valuation, unlocking asset value while Kuaishou retains control; Buy

1024.HK	12m Price Target: **HK$68.00**	Price: **HK$42.60**	Upside: **59.6%**

BUY

Lincoln Kong, CFA
+852-2978-6603 | lincoln.kong@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

Ronald Keung, CFA
+852-2978-0856 | ronald.keung@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

Luqing Zhou
+852-3465-4207 | luqing.zhou@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

What happened?

Kuaishou announced that a Capital Increase Agreement has been signed on Jul 2, 2026, for Kling's external financing. Under the transaction, a consortium of Initial Investors agreed to inject an initial US$2.03bn (c. RMB13.8bn) into Beijing Kling, and a further US$766mn (c. RMB5.2bn) has already been committed by 15 Additional Investors through Joinder Agreements. The company also reserved capacity for potential further investors, with **total fundraising capped at US$3bn** (c. US$2.8bn has already been committed according to the company's announcement), representing up to **16.67%** of Kling's enlarged share capital. The investors include a wide spectrum across Internet platforms, China based private equity and AI focused industry funds etc.

Alongside the financing, the company also announced approval for a comprehensive employee participation program comprising a Beijing Kling share incentive plan, Beijing Kling share ownership and Beijing Kling share option schemes. The aggregate authorization pool accounts for **15%** of Kling's enlarged share capital, with an **initial grant representing 7.45%** of Kling's enlarged share capital already being approved. Kuaishou's founder and Kling's CEO Mr. Gai Kun received among the largest grants.

The financing would imply a **US$15bn pre-money valuation** for Kling. Assuming both the full subscription limit and the entire employee incentive pool are ultimately utilized, Kuaishou's equity interests in Kling would be diluted from 100% to **68.33%** upon the completion of transaction. Despite this dilution, Kuaishou will continue consolidating Kling's financial results.

Kling's financial disclosure

According to the announcement, the company disclosed that Kling generated c. **Rmb1.1bn** revenue in 2025. More notably, Kling's ARR

Key Data

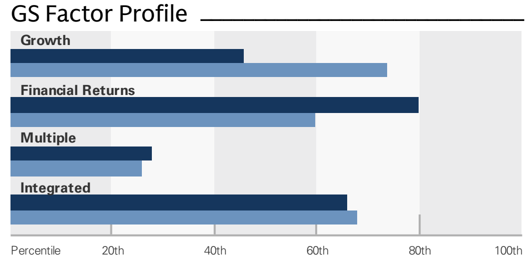
Market cap:	HK$181.6bn / $23.2bn
Enterprise value:	HK$166.6bn / $21.2bn
3m ADTV:	HK$2.6bn / $326.3mn
	Hong Kong
	China Games, Entertainment & Healthcare Tech
M&A Rank:	3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?:	Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn)	142,776.0	145,323.0	153,203.5	164,295.7
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	30,472.0	28,450.6	32,659.0	36,870.8
EPS (Rmb)	4.69	3.70	4.24	4.92
P/E (X)	12.3	10.0	8.7	7.5
P/B (X)	3.2	1.8	1.5	1.2
Dividend yield (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(0.3)	(1.1)	(1.4)	(1.8)
CROCI (%)	(2.3)	37.6	35.6	35.4
FCF yield (%)	3.2	3.5	8.5	11.0

	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (Rmb)	0.77	0.90	0.95	1.07

GS Factor Profile



1024.HK relative to Asia ex. Japan Coverage
1024.HK relative to China Games, Entertainment & Healthcare Tech

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates. See disclosures for details.

Kuaishou Technology (1024.HK)

BUY

Rating since Sep 4, 2022

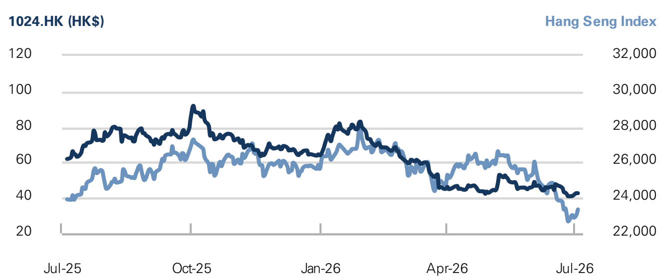
Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	12.3	10.0	8.7	7.5
P/B (X)	3.2	1.8	1.5	1.2
FCF yield (%)	3.2	3.5	8.5	11.0
EV/EBITDAR (X)	8.1	5.1	4.1	3.1
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	8.7	5.3	4.1	3.1
CROCI (%)	(2.3)	37.6	35.6	35.4
ROE (%)	29.2	18.7	18.4	17.8
Net debt/equity (%)	0.9	(14.4)	(24.3)	(33.8)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	(11.6)	(29.8)	(37.8)	(45.5)
Interest cover (X)	25.3	15.3	15.0	17.3
Days inventory outst, sales	–	–	–	–
Receivable days	18.9	20.8	20.5	20.1
Days payable outstanding	183.4	174.1	178.2	177.7
DuPont ROE (%)	25.9	17.6	16.9	16.4
Turnover (X)	0.9	0.7	0.7	0.7
Leverage (X)	2.1	2.2	2.0	1.9
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (Rmb)	60,279.0	76,100.8	87,223.1	97,987.9
Average capital employed (Rmb)	59,849.5	67,042.5	65,799.8	69,517.3
BVPS (Rmb)	18.07	21.04	25.14	30.06

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	12.5	1.8	5.4	7.2
EBITDA growth	23.0	(6.6)	14.8	12.9
EPS growth	16.7	(21.1)	14.6	16.0
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
EBIT margin	16.3	13.1	14.5	15.4
EBITDA margin	21.3	19.6	21.3	22.4
Net income margin	14.5	11.0	12.0	13.0

Price Performance



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	(5.1)%	(35.7)%	(30.3)%
Rel. to the Hang Seng Index	2.1%	(27.5)%	(28.1)%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 3 Jul 2026 close.

Income Statement (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	142,776.0	145,323.0	153,203.5	164,295.7
Cost of goods sold	(63,893.5)	(70,064.4)	(72,592.7)	(76,096.8)
SG&A	(45,016.8)	(44,292.0)	(45,019.4)	(47,830.8)
R&D	(12,739.7)	(14,990.0)	(16,375.5)	(18,024.0)
Other operating inc./(exp.)	2,151.0	3,022.0	2,965.1	2,970.8
EBITDA	**30,472.0**	**28,450.6**	**32,659.0**	**36,870.8**
Depreciation & amortization	(7,195.0)	(9,452.1)	(10,478.1)	(11,555.8)
EBIT	**23,277.0**	**18,998.5**	**22,180.9**	**25,315.0**
Net interest inc./(exp.)	(149.0)	(551.2)	(522.1)	(183.1)
Income/(loss) from associates	–	–	–	–
Pre-tax profit	**22,495.0**	**18,447.3**	**21,658.8**	**25,131.9**
Provision for taxes	(1,848.0)	(2,490.4)	(3,248.8)	(3,769.8)
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Preferred dividends	–	–	–	–
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	**20,647.0**	**15,956.9**	**18,410.0**	**21,362.1**
Post-tax exceptionals	(2,023.0)	(2,906.5)	(3,064.1)	(3,285.9)
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	**18,624.0**	**13,050.4**	**15,345.9**	**18,076.2**
EPS (basic, pre-except) (Rmb)	**4.82**	**3.70**	**4.24**	**4.92**
EPS (diluted, pre-except) (Rmb)	**4.69**	**3.70**	**4.24**	**4.92**
EPS (basic, post-except) (Rmb)	**4.35**	**3.03**	**3.53**	**4.16**
EPS (diluted, post-except) (Rmb)	**4.23**	**3.03**	**3.53**	**4.16**
DPS (Rmb)	–	–	–	–
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

Balance Sheet (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	11,180.0	28,986.8	41,255.4	59,355.9
Accounts receivable	8,127.0	8,431.7	8,818.2	9,313.3
Inventory	–	–	–	–
Other current assets	58,233.0	58,358.4	58,746.3	59,292.3
Total current assets	**77,549.0**	**95,776.9**	**108,819.9**	**127,961.5**
Net PP&E	31,414.0	46,745.2	53,202.2	59,232.5
Net intangibles	986.0	911.7	833.4	749.4
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	54,406.0	54,664.7	54,923.3	55,182.0
Total assets	**164,504.0**	**198,247.5**	**217,927.8**	**243,274.3**
Accounts payable	32,057.0	34,772.0	36,119.1	37,992.0
Short-term debt	1,968.0	1,968.0	–	–
Short-term lease liabilities	3,962.0	5,579.1	5,863.3	6,053.7
Other current liabilities	29,548.0	32,371.9	33,550.2	35,184.0
Total current liabilities	**67,535.0**	**74,691.0**	**75,532.6**	**79,229.8**
Long-term debt	–	–	–	–
Long-term lease liabilities	5,977.0	8,416.6	8,845.2	9,132.5
Other long-term liabilities	280.0	280.0	280.0	280.0
Total long-term liabilities	**17,385.0**	**32,824.6**	**33,253.2**	**33,540.5**
Total liabilities	**84,920.0**	**107,515.6**	**108,785.9**	**112,770.3**
Preferred shares	–	–	–	–
Total common equity	79,558.0	90,705.9	109,115.9	130,478.0
Minority interest	**26.0**	**26.0**	**26.0**	**26.0**
Total liabilities & equity	**164,504.0**	**198,247.5**	**217,927.8**	**243,274.3**
Net debt, adjusted	(9,212.0)	(27,018.8)	(41,255.4)	(59,355.9)

Cash Flow (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	20,472.0	15,540.8	18,594.7	21,846.0
D&A add-back	7,195.0	9,452.1	10,478.1	11,555.8
Minority interest add-back	–	–	–	–
Net (inc)/dec working capital	27,965.0	5,108.8	1,751.1	2,465.6
Other operating cash flow	(1,094.0)	157.4	(443.4)	(742.5)
Cash flow from operations	**26,716.0**	**30,259.1**	**30,380.5**	**35,124.8**
Capital expenditures	(14,942.0)	(24,709.0)	(16,856.7)	(17,502.1)
Acquisitions	–	–	–	–
Divestitures	–	–	–	–
Others	(11,314.0)	0.0	–	–
Cash flow from investing	**(26,256.0)**	**(24,709.0)**	**(16,856.7)**	**(17,502.1)**
Repayment of lease liabilities	(3,823.0)	–	–	0.0
Dividends paid (common & pref)	–	–	–	–
Inc/(dec) in debt	1,599.0	13,000.0	(1,968.0)	–
Other financing cash flows	247.0	(743.3)	712.8	477.7
Cash flow from financing	**(1,977.0)**	**12,256.7**	**(1,255.2)**	**477.7**
Total cash flow	**(5,961.2)**	**17,806.8**	**12,268.6**	**18,100.5**
Free cash flow	7,951.0	5,550.1	13,523.8	17,622.7

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

reached c. **US$500mn** in Mar 2026, highlighting the fast pace of Kling's commercialization achieved in less than 2 years after the launch of Kling 1.0 in Jun 2024. The scale of revenue generation already places Kling among the largest monetized AI-native video applications globally, supported by enterprise API services and subscription revenues.

At the same time, the company remains in a heavy investment phase. Kling disclosed an unaudited net loss of c. Rmb500mn in 2024, which expanded to **Rmb1.9bn net loss in 2025** as model training/inference, infrastructure investment and commercialization efforts accelerated.

Implications and GS view

1. Fresh capital and equity incentive plans for talent significantly strengthens Kling's competitive position. In our view, the most immediate benefit from the transaction would be financial flexibility. The potential US$3bn capital injection in Kling should support continued investment in its model training, inference infrastructure, GPU procurement and global market expansion. Management indicated in the announcement that proceeds will be used for business expansion, daily operations, team development and other growth initiatives. As competition increasingly shifts from algorithm innovation alone toward compute resource availability and ecosystem scale, and talent is crucial to continuously improve model capability, access to capital and sufficient equity incentive plans for talent has become a key competitive component. We believe the financing and equity incentive plans will materially improve Kling's ability to sustain model leadership and should help attract/retain talent over the medium-to-long term.

2. External financing helps to reduce Kuaishou's future cash flow burden. We view the transaction as a strategic capital allocation decision by Kuaishou. While Kling has emerged as one of the company's most strategically important growth initiatives, funding AI model development solely through Kuaishou's balance sheet would likely become increasingly expensive given the magnitude of infrastructure spending required. By introducing external investors, Kuaishou would effectively share future funding requirements while maintaining strategic control over the asset. The arrangement therefore should alleviate pressure on Kuaishou's cash resources and provide greater flexibility to balance shareholder returns, core platform investments and AI development simultaneously.

3. Diversified investor base could potentially create additional ecosystem opportunities. Beyond capital, the composition of the investor syndicate could offer potential business synergy or strategic collaboration opportunities, across cloud infrastructure, enterprise software, AI applications and industrial deployment scenarios. While no such partnerships have been disclosed, the inclusion of external investors could potentially broaden Kling's access to enterprise customers, technical resources and ecosystem partnerships over time. We believe the investor mix reflects growing industry recognition that AI video generation is evolving beyond a consumer creative tool into a broader platform technology with applications across advertising, e-commerce, gaming, film production and content creation, etc.

4. The transaction establishes a clearer valuation benchmark to assess Kuaishou's SOTP. How to evaluate Kling within Kuaishou's broader social media and advertising ecosystem, and thus its impact on Kuishou's valuation, has been a key investor debate. With the agreed financing implying a market-tested **US$15bn pre-money valuation** (indicating a **US$18bn post-money valuation**) based on a wide range of diversified institutional investors, this creates a clearer SOTP framework for investors to assess Kuaishou's core business fundamentals and the impact of Kling's growth potential on the company.

At US$18bn post money valuation, and given the 68.33% stake Kuaishou owns, all things equal, the implied market cap for Kuaishou's main platform (excluding Kling) would be US$10.9bn, or 4X PE in 2026.

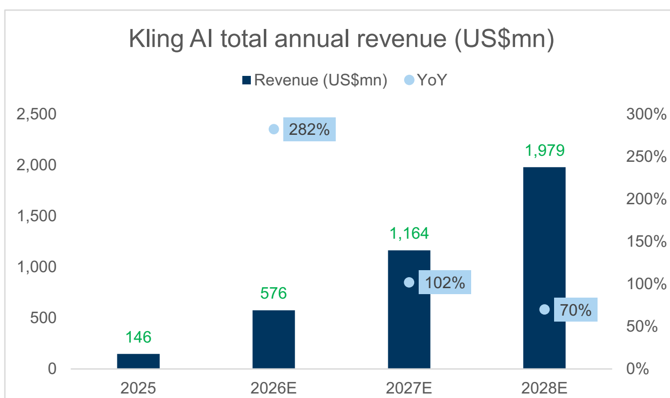
What's next: 1) we would look for more updates from Kling on next model upgrades (possibly within month) and ARR trend in 2Q, 2) Progress on potential Kling spin-off after this round of financing.

Exhibit 1: Kuaishou will own 68.3% stake post financing

Kling share ownership		
Controlling shareholders	**Before financing**	**Post financing**
Kuaishou	100%	68.3%
Shareholding platform		
Cheng Yixiao		1%
Gai Kun		3%
Other employees incentives		11%
Other investors		16.7%

Source: Company filings

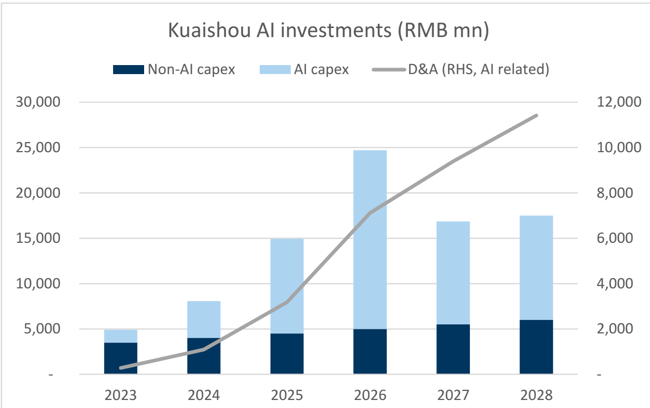
Exhibit 2: Kling AI: We expect Kling AI's total annual revenue to reach US$576mn in 2026E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

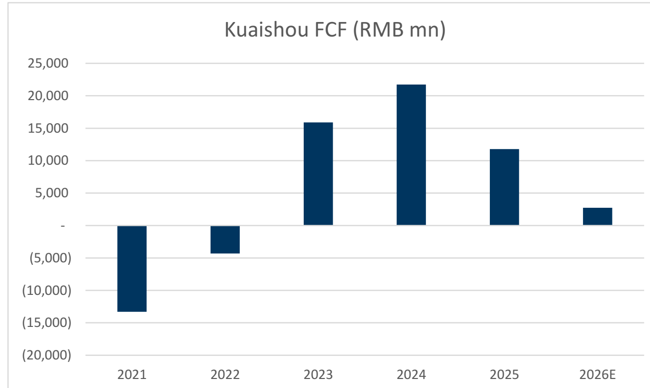
Key highlights

Exhibit 3: Kuaishou AI investments: Capex vs. D&A



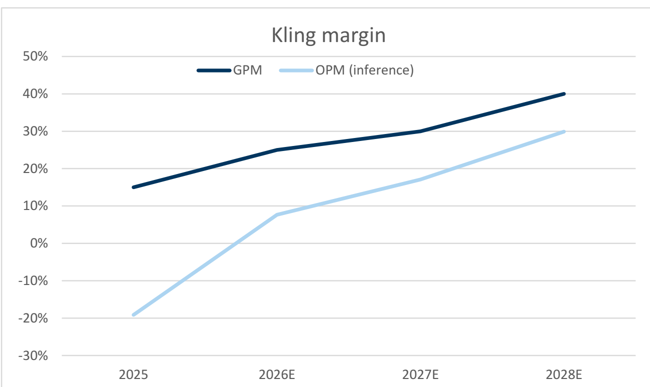
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: We see limited positive FCF for Kuaishou in 2026E



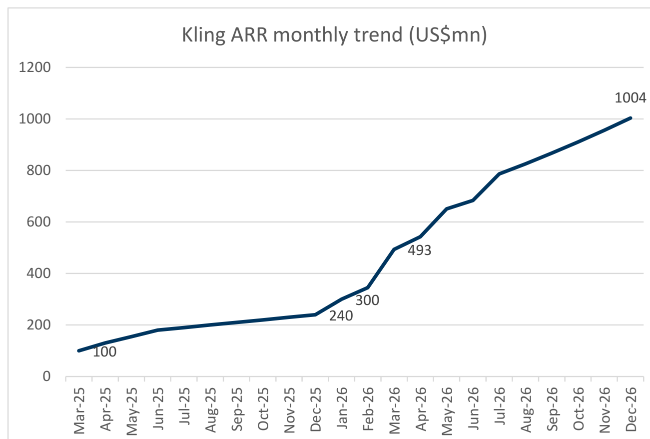
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Kling AI: We expect inference level GPM % and OPM % to continue ramping up



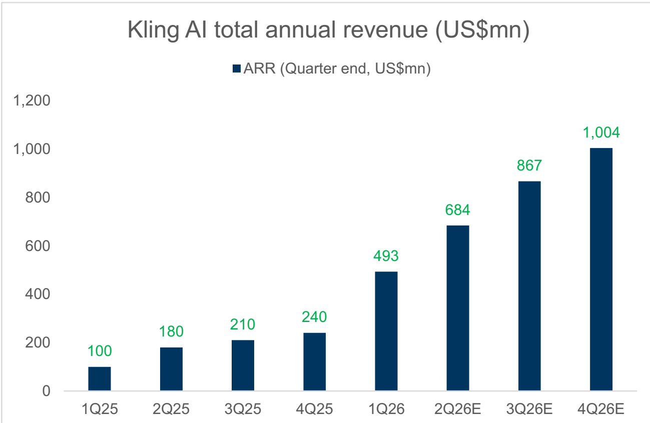
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Kling AI: We expect ARR monthly trend to continue ramping up in 2026E



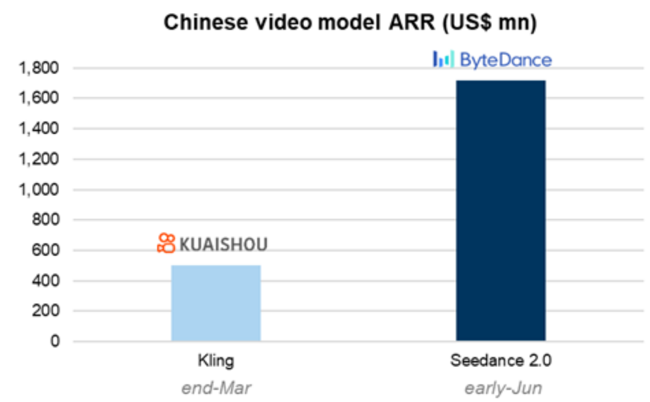
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: Kling AI: ARR trend by quarter-end



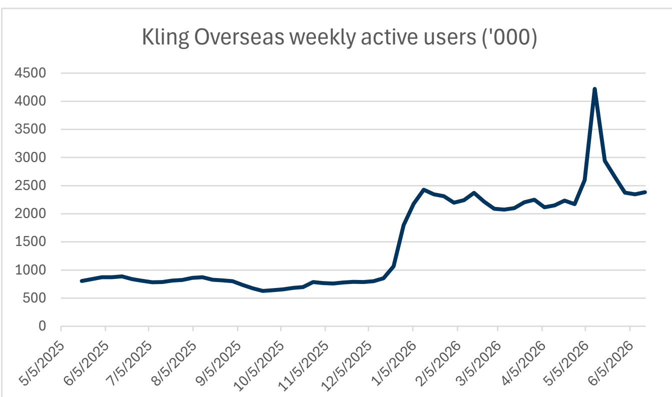
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: Kling ARR vs. Seedance ARR



Source: Company data, 36kr, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: Kling AI overseas weekly active users saw a strong surge in early May propelled by video clips gaining popularity though normalized afterwards



Source: SensorTower, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: Our 12-m target price is HK$68

P/E valuation	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	Avg. 2026-27E
Net profit (Non-Gaap)	17,716	20,647	15,957	18,410	17,183
PE (X)			15.0x	15.0x	15.0x
Equity value (RMB mn)		309,705	239,354	276,150	257,752
Equity value (US$ mn)		44,885	34,689	40,022	37,355
12-m target price (HK$)					68

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Updating our previous research, we assess Kuaishou's implied value per share with a SOTP valuation cross-check.

Exhibit 11: Kuaishou: Current share price implies a 4.5X P/E for the Main Platform and a valuation of US$11.5bn for Kling

Current share price implied valuation					
2026E (Rmb mn)	**Revenue**	**Net profit**	**Multiple**	**Rmb mn**	**US$mn**
Kuaishou Main platform	141,347	18,863	4.5X P/E	84,885	12,302
Kling AI	3,976	(2,906)	20X P/S	79,511	11,523
Group total	**145,323**	**15,957**	**10.3**	**164,396**	**23,825**
Implied value per share (HK$)				43	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: Our TP implies a valuation of US$17bn for Kling at a 7.5x P/E for the Main platform

Base case (Cross-check)				Valuation	
2026E (Rmb mn)	**Revenue**	**Net profit**	**Multiple**	**Rmb mn**	**US$mn**
Kuaishou Main platform	141,347	18,863	7.5X P/E	141,475	20,504
Kling AI	3,976	(2,906)	30X P/S	119,266	17,285
Group total	**145,323**	**15,957**	**16.3**	**260,741**	**37,789**
Implied value per share (HK$)				68	

Base case / implied value per share represents our 12m target price

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: Applying 10-25X P/ARR on US$1bn end-26E ARR implies a valuation of US$10-25bn for Kling AI

Kling implied valuation (US$bn)		end-26E ARR of US$1bn
Kling P/ARR (end 26E)	10	10
	15	15
	20	20
	25	25

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

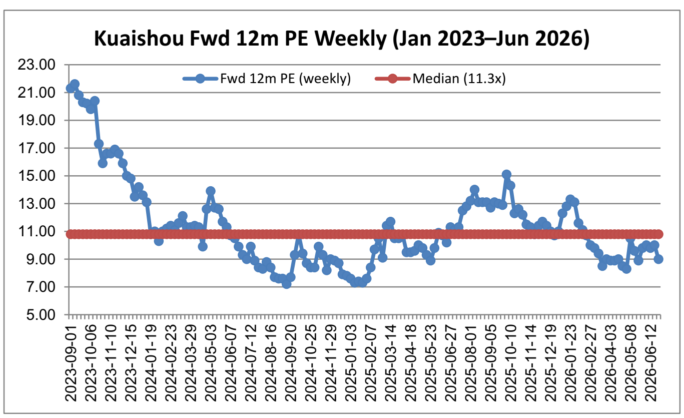
Exhibit 14: Kuaishou: cross-check SOTP valuation sensitivity analysis

Assuming Platform P/E of 5-11X and Kling P/ARR of 10-25X on US$1bn end-2026E ARR, and 10% holdco discount

Kuaishou value per share (HK$)		Main platform P/E (2026E)			
		5	7	9	11
Kling P/ARR (end 26E)	10	39	48	57	66
	15	47	56	65	74
	20	56	65	74	83
	25	64	73	82	91

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: Kuaishou: 12m-fwd P/E in the past 3 years



Source: Workspace, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Kuaishou financial summary

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Kuaishou Technology

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on Kuaishou with a 12m target price of **HK$68**, based on P/E valuation (target P/E multiple of 15X applied to our avg. 2026E-27E EPS).

Key downside risks: 1) Slower-than-expected ad budget recovery; 2) Weaker-than-expected Kling monetization; 3) Slower-than-expected growth of its aggregate user engagement base (DAU x time spent per DAU); 4) Lower-than-expected profitability; 5) Weaker-than-expected AI progress.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Lincoln Kong, CFA, Ronald Keung, CFA and Luqing Zhou, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

Contributing Authors: Lincoln Kong, CFA Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Ronald Keung, CFA Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Luqing Zhou Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C..

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed in the Contributing Authors disclosure of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

GS Factor Profile

The Goldman Sachs Factor Profile provides investment context for a stock by comparing key attributes to the market (i.e. our universe of rated stocks) and its sector peers. The four key attributes depicted are: Growth, Financial Returns, Multiple (e.g. valuation) and Integrated (a composite of Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple). Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple are calculated by using normalized ranks for specific metrics for each stock. The normalized ranks for the metrics are then averaged and converted into percentiles for the relevant attribute. The precise calculation of each metric may vary depending on the fiscal year, industry and region, but the standard approach is as follows:

Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

For a more detailed description of how we calculate the GS Factor Profile, please contact your GS representative.

M&A Rank

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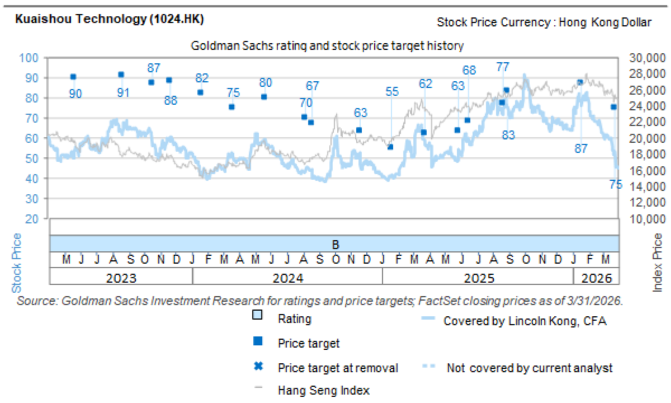
Price target and rating history chart(s)



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Target price history table(s)

Kuaishou Technology (1024.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK$)	Closing price (HK$)
29-Jun-26	68.00	41.00
27-May-26	70.00	45.28
14-May-26	74.00	50.85
25-Mar-26	75.00	53.05
18-Jan-26	87.00	78.35
31-Aug-25	83.00	75.35
21-Aug-25	77.00	71.75
17-Jun-25	68.00	59.40
27-May-25	63.00	48.75
25-Mar-25	62.00	56.80
19-Jan-25	55.00	40.75
20-Nov-24	63.00	52.55
20-Aug-24	67.00	44.40
08-Aug-24	70.00	43.85
22-May-24	80.00	58.15
20-Mar-24	75.00	52.25
21-Jan-24	82.00	41.55
21-Nov-23	88.00	58.50
19-Oct-23	87.00	56.10
22-Aug-23	91.00	62.50

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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